

THE MOTION

This Club Believes that

Respecting personal autonomy requires society to tolerate self destructive choices

Mark where you stand before a word is spoken.
Mark it again on the way out.

STEP IN ☐ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ LEAVE THEM TO IT

WHAT THE WORDS MEAN

PERSONAL AUTONOMY

A competent adult's capacity to make informed, voluntary decisions about their own life, by their own values, with nobody coercing them.

SELF DESTRUCTIVE CHOICES

Decisions that risk serious physical, psychological, financial or social harm, mainly to the person making them. Refusing treatment, addiction, gambling, extreme sport, assisted dying.

TOLERATE

To refrain from prohibiting, preventing or punishing a choice you disagree with. Not the same as approving of it. The motion asks whether society should allow, not whether it should applaud.

THE REAL DISAGREEMENT

BOTH SIDES AGREE

Autonomy matters, and society has some duty to prevent serious harm. Neither side denies either, and both accept that some limits on choice are already justified.

THEY SPLIT ON

Is stopping someone from seriously harming themselves a legitimate exercise of social responsibility, or an unjustified exercise of control over their life?

WHERE EACH SIDE STARTS

FOR THE MOTION

An adult who knowingly chooses something that harms mainly themselves should be left to it, however unwise the choice looks from outside.

AGAINST

Autonomy is not absolute. Where the harm is severe or irreversible, or consent is compromised, society may legitimately restrict the choice.

HOW THE NIGHT RUNS

1

The motion is revealed.
This sheet is the first anyone sees of it.

2

Vote on it before a word is spoken.

3

Debaters are drawn at random. If your name comes out, you argue.

4

The teams have their say, then the floor opens to the room.

5

Vote again. The room decides who moved it.

YOUR CASE

Your points, in your own words. Write the trigger, not the speech. The rest you say on stage.

1

BECAUSE

2

BECAUSE

3

BECAUSE

4

BECAUSE

WHILE THEY SPEAK

Answer what was said.

Write down their claim as they made it, not the weaker version that is easy to knock over. Then write your answer beside it. One row, one exchange.

THEY SAID	MY ANSWER
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	

THE ONE SENTENCE

The last thing you say is the thing the room votes on. Write it before you stand up.
